OpenClaw Switch Models

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1. Course Content

This course will systematically introduce the model selection working mechanism of OpenClaw and three methods for model switching operations.

2. Temporarily Switch Session Model

2.1 Open TUI Session

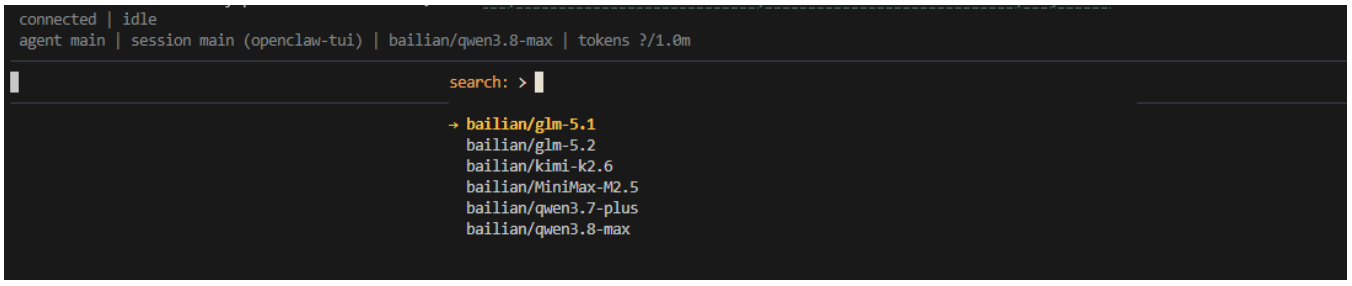
- Enter in terminal

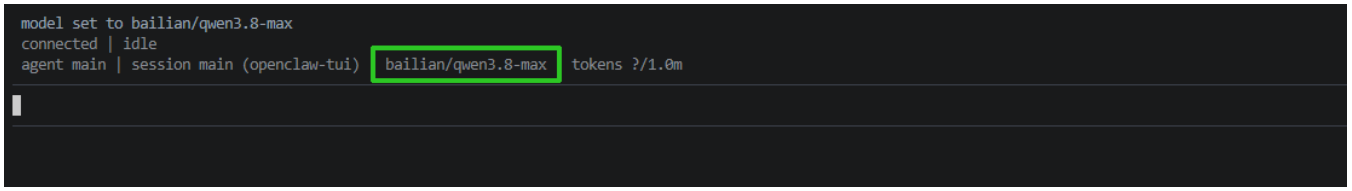
```
openclaw tui
```

2.2 Use /model to Switch Session Model

Command	Description
`/model`	View available model list and select to switch model

- Enter `/model` in the session input box. For example, here we choose to switch to `bailian/qwen3.8-max`. Use the up and down arrow keys to select a model, then press Enter.





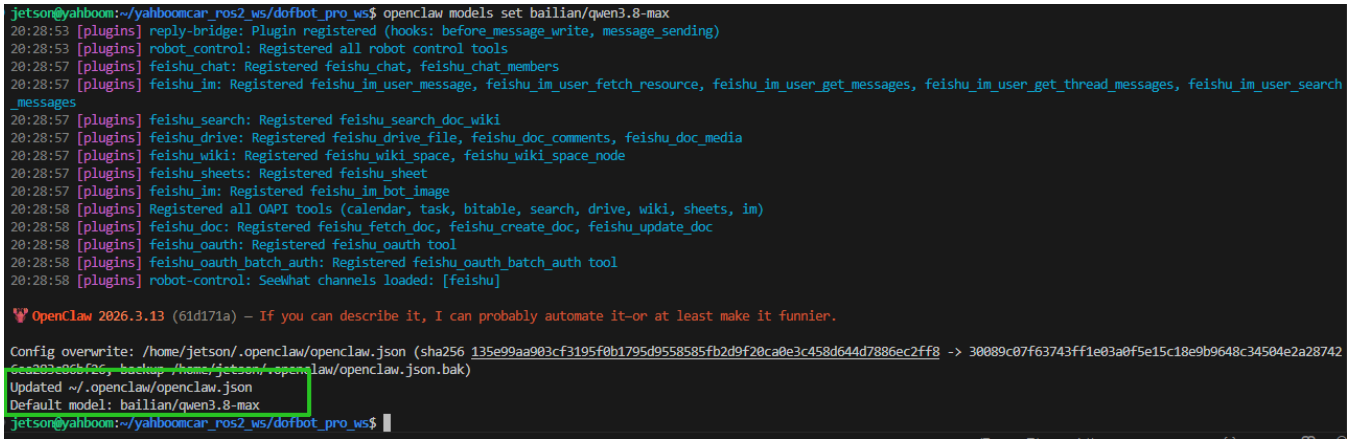
3. Switch Default Model

3.1 Switch via CLI

The simplest way is to use the CLI command to directly set the default model:

- Here we take switching to `bailian/qwen3.8-max` model as an example

```
openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.8-max
```



3.2 Switch via Configuration File

- Edit the `openclaw.json` configuration file to modify the Agent's default model

```
nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json
# Or use your favorite editor, such as vim, code, etc. It is recommended to modify through IDEs like vscode for easier operation
```

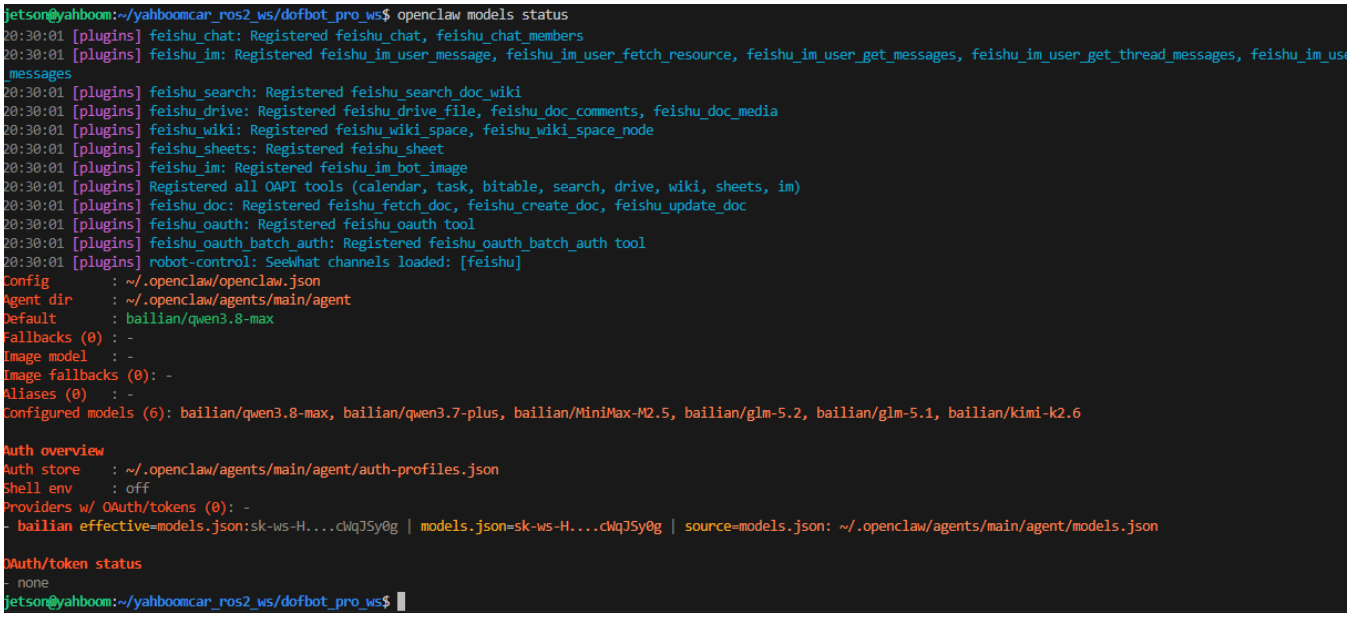
In `openclaw.json`, specify the default primary model through the `agents.defaults.model.primary` configuration item:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.8-max"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

```
34    "agents": {
35      "defaults": {
36        "model": {
37          "primary": "bailian/qwen3.8-max"
38        },
39        "models": {
```

- Verify if the configuration takes effect:

```
openclaw models status
```



4. Add Model Options List

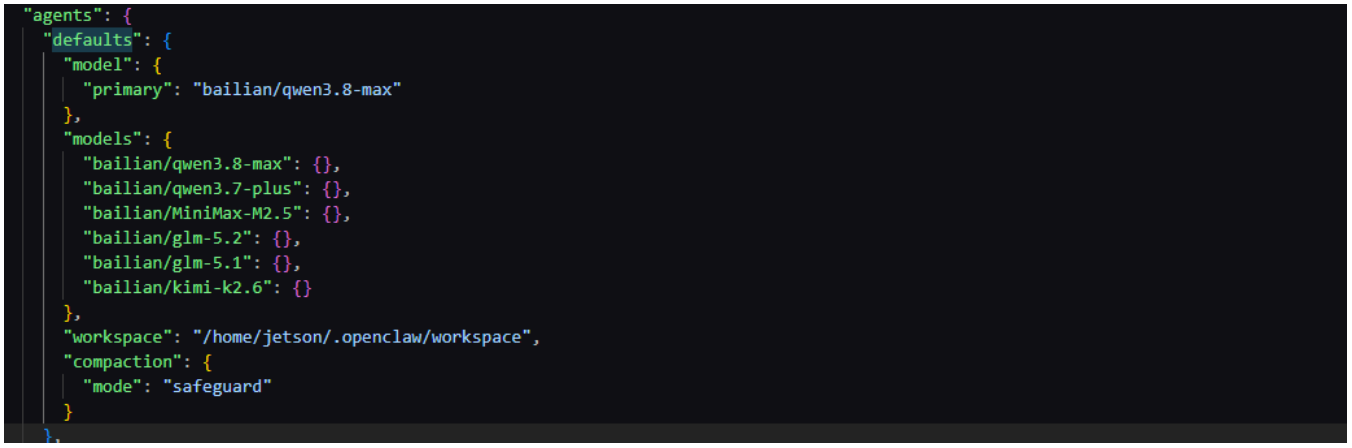
- `agents.defaults.models` is the **allow list/directory** that controls the available model range in OpenClaw. When this configuration item is set, users can only use models included in the list. This list serves as the basis for model range control for both the `/model` command and session overrides.

4.1 Add Models via Configuration File

Configure `agents.defaults.models` in `openclaw.json`. Add the models you need to use to the allow list:

```
"agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.8-max"
      },
      "models": {
        "bailian/qwen3.8-max": {},
        "bailian/qwen3.7-plus": {},
        "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
        "bailian/glm-5.2": {},
        "bailian/glm-5.1": {},
        "bailian/kimi-k2.6": {}
```

```
      },
      "workspace": "/home/jetson/.openclaw/workspace",
      "compaction": {
        "mode": "safeguard"
      }
    },
```



4.2 Model Reference Format Specification

In OpenClaw, all model references use a unified format:

```
provider/modelID
```

Examples:

Model Reference	Description
`anthropic/claude-opus-4-6`	Anthropic's Claude Opus model
`anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6`	Anthropic's Claude Sonnet model
`openai/gpt-5.4`	OpenAI's GPT-5.4 model
`openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2`	Case where the model ID itself contains a slash

> **Note**: If the model ID itself contains `/` (such as `moonshotai/kimi-k2`), you must provide the complete reference in the format `openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2`.